

TEACHER QUICK START

Party inquiry, ready to teach

Grades 6-7 | two 40-minute blocks | research, critique, create, discuss

LEARNING GOAL

Students compare current proposals, test a criticism with evidence, and explain a reasoned view. A personal party preference is optional.

BEFORE STUDENTS ARRIVE

- Select one shared provincial issue. Prepare two or three current, age-appropriate source excerpts from each party you include, plus one credible account of a criticism and any party reply. Date every excerpt.
- Offer the same source time and the same comparison headings for every party. A short, teacher-curated source folder works with shared devices or printed copies.
- Print pages 3-6 for each student or pair. Use page 7 as discussion cards. Keep pages 1-2 and 8 for planning and assessment.

SOURCE STARTING POINTS

- Elections BC: elections.bc.ca/2026-provincial-election/
- Registered parties: elections.bc.ca/candidates-parties/political-parties/
- Party starting points: bcndp.ca | conservativebc.ca | bcgreens.ca (check the complete registered-party list too)
- Student Vote: studentvote.ca/ | Elections BC education: elections.bc.ca/voting/outreach-and-education/educational-resources/

PARTICIPATION CHOICES

- Students may research a party they favour, compare several, or keep their own choice private. Nobody reports a family vote.
- Use anonymous questions, paired conversation, drawing, or writing so students can contribute without a public speech.
- Check school guidance before posting party materials or running public campaign-style activities. Keep the teacher role even-handed.

TEACHER RUN SHEET

Two lessons, one clear product

Project the four Equity Hub screens; these timings can stretch or compress.

BLOCK A - INVESTIGATE (40 MINUTES)

- 0-5: Ask: Which decisions are provincial? Choose one shared issue; clarify that claims, predictions, and values are different.
- 5-17: Model a source record on page 3: exact proposal, party, date, and link. Students examine equal excerpts from two or more parties.
- 17-30: Fill page 4 using the same issue and headings for each party. Say 'not found in sources checked' rather than inventing a position.
- 30-40: Begin page 5. Read one criticism aloud; identify the critic, evidence, party response, uncertainty, and affected perspectives.

BLOCK B - MAKE AND DISCUSS (40 MINUTES)

- 0-7: Revisit the criticism. Ask: What is established, what is predicted, and what is someone's opinion?
- 7-24: Students use page 6 to draft an infographic on paper or a slide. Require a proposal, comparison, criticism and response, an open question, and sources.
- 24-35: Pair or gallery conversation using page 7. Invite a respectful challenge and an honest 'I do not know yet.'
- 35-40: Revise one claim and complete the exit reflection on page 8. A secret mock vote is optional and separate from assessment.

TEACHER MODEL: A CRITICISM WITHOUT A VERDICT

Frame: 'The party proposes _____. A critic argues _____ because _____. The party responds _____. The evidence we can check is _____. The unresolved question is _____.'

LOOK FOR

- Accurate description of at least two parties on the same issue, with a date and source for each claim.
- A criticism attributed to its source, a party response if available, and a clear distinction between fact, prediction, and opinion.
- A reasoned personal view if the student chooses to share one; a change of mind also counts as strong thinking.

STUDENT PAGE 1

Follow the source

Name: _____ Date checked: _____

Our shared issue

Party or candidate I am investigating

SOURCE 1 - PARTY'S OWN WORDS

Title / organization / web address

Publication or update date

One exact proposal in my own words

Evidence that this is what the party actually proposes

SOURCE 2 - ANOTHER PARTY ON THE SAME ISSUE

Title / organization / web address

Publication or update date

Its proposal in my own words

CHECK: Is this a current proposal, an older promise, a campaign ad, or someone's opinion?

STUDENT PAGE 2

Compare the same question

Name: _____ Issue: _____

Use the same issue for each column. Write 'not found in sources checked' if needed.

COMPARE	PARTY 1	PARTY 2	PARTY 3 / OPTIONAL
Party name			
What it proposes			
Who might benefit?			
Concern or trade-off			
Source and date			

One difference that matters to me:

STUDENT PAGE 3

Test a criticism

Name: _____ Party being examined: _____

The proposal - what did the party actually say? Source and date:

The criticism - who raised it, and what exactly do they claim? Source and date:

Evidence - what can we verify? Which part is prediction or opinion?

Party response - what does the party say? If none found, where did you look?

Who may be affected? Whose perspective is missing?

One fair question I would ask this party:

Repeat these questions for another party. Strong scrutiny uses the same standard.

STUDENT PAGE 4

Plan an evidence infographic

Use the same headings as classmates. Draw here, then make your final version.

1 / PROPOSAL

What does this party say it would do? Add a source and date.

2 / COMPARISON

How does another party approach the same issue?

3 / CRITICISM + RESPONSE

Who raises the concern? What does the party reply?

4 / WHAT IS UNCERTAIN?

What evidence is missing? Who may be affected?

5 / AN OPEN QUESTION

Ask something a voter could investigate before deciding.

6 / SOURCES

List the original sources and the date you checked them.

OPTIONAL PERSONAL VIEW: I would support ____ because ____ . Evidence: ____

You may keep your preference private. Do not ask classmates how their families vote.

DISCUSSION CARDS

Ask a question that helps

Cut out or project. Listen to the answer; ask for a source before judging the person.

CLARIFY

What does the party mean by that proposal? Where can we read its own words?

COMPARE

What does another party propose for the same issue?

CHECK

What evidence supports the criticism? Is any part a prediction?

RESPOND

Has the party answered this concern? What remains unanswered?

EQUITY

Who might benefit or face a barrier? Whose view is missing?

RECONSIDER

What new evidence could change your view?

Conversation routine: explain accurately / invite a question / answer from evidence

Useful answer: 'I do not know yet. I will check.'

Afterward, revise one claim on your infographic.

EXIT TICKET + TEACHER CHECK

What changed in your thinking?

Name: _____ Date: _____

One claim I changed or made more precise after checking sources:

One criticism or response I still need to investigate:

What evidence could change your current view? (You do not need to name a party.)

TEACHER CHECK - CIRCLE A LEVEL FOR EACH

Uses dated, traceable sources for party proposals	1	2	3	4
Compares parties on the same issue	1	2	3	4
Attributes criticism and includes a response or honest gap	1	2	3	4
Distinguishes fact, prediction, and opinion	1	2	3	4
Asks and answers questions respectfully	1	2	3	4

Feedback / next step:
